

PROJECT PROPOSAL

CREATION

A Complete Guide for Masters Students

Learn how to plan, structure,
and present your research proposal
with confidence.

**6-Month
Project
Guide**

What is a Project Proposal?

DEFINITION

A project proposal is a formal document that outlines what you plan to research or build, why it matters, how you will do it, and how long it will take. It is the blueprint of your entire project.

PURPOSE

Convince your supervisor that your project is feasible and worthwhile.

PLANNING TOOL

Helps you think through every stage of your project before starting.

CONTRACT

Sets clear expectations for deliverables, timeline, and approach.

Structure of a Project Proposal

01 Title Page

02 Introduction & Background

03 Problem Statement

04 Aim & Objectives

05 Literature Review

06 Methodology

07 Gantt Chart / Timeline

08 Expected Outcomes

09 References

01 & 02 | Title Page & Introduction

TITLE PAGE

- Project title (clear and specific)
- Student name & index number
- Supervisor's name
- Institution / Department
- Date of submission
- Programme

INTRODUCTION & BACKGROUND

- Brief overview of the project topic
- Background context (why this area is relevant now)
- Current situation in the field
- Gaps or needs that exist
- Why you chose this topic
- Scope: what is and is NOT covered

03 & 04 | Problem Statement & Aim / Objectives



PROBLEM STATEMENT

What to include:

- Describe the specific problem clearly
- Explain the impact of the problem
- State who is affected and how
- Provide evidence (statistics, reports)
- Explain why existing solutions are insufficient



Tip: Start with "The problem is..." and be specific!



AIM & OBJECTIVES

AIM (1 sentence):

A broad statement of what the project will achieve overall.

OBJECTIVES (SMART):

- S – Specific
- M – Measurable
- A – Achievable
- R – Realistic
- T – Time-bound



Use 3–5 objectives. Start each with an action verb: "To design...", "To develop..."

05 | Literature Review

A literature review is a critical summary of existing research, theories, and studies related to your topic. It shows that you understand the field and identifies gaps your project will address.



Relevant Theories

Discuss key theories and models related to your topic area.



Previous Studies

Summarise 5–10 journal articles, books, or credible online sources.



Research Gaps

Point out what has NOT been studied — this justifies YOUR project.



Link to Your Work

Explain how existing literature connects to your proposed project.



Cite all sources using Harvard referencing style. Use Google Scholar, ResearchGate, or your library database.

06 | Methodology

Methodology explains HOW you will carry out your project — the step-by-step process, tools, and techniques you will use to achieve your objectives.



Research Approach

Qualitative (interviews, observations) OR Quantitative (surveys, data analysis) OR Mixed Methods.



Data Collection

Primary data (surveys, interviews, experiments) or Secondary data (books, articles, reports).



Tools & Technologies

Software (e.g., Python, MySQL, Figma), hardware, or frameworks you will use.



Development Method

Agile / Waterfall / Prototyping — explain which model fits your project and why.



Ethical Considerations

Consent forms, data privacy, confidentiality of participants (if surveys/interviews used).



Limitations

Acknowledge constraints: time, budget, access to data, or technical limitations.

07 | Gantt Chart / Project Timeline

A Gantt chart is a visual timeline that shows project tasks on the left and weeks/months across the top. Coloured bars show when each task starts and ends.

Task / Activity	Month 1				Month 2				Month 3			
	W1	W2	W3	W4	W1	W2	W3	W4	W1	W2	W3	W4
Topic Selection & Proposal Draft	Active	Active	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed
Literature Review	Active	Active	Active	Active	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed
Research Methodology Design	Completed	Completed	Active	Active	Active	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed
Data Collection	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Active	Active	Active	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed
Data Analysis	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Active	Active	Active	Completed	Completed	Completed
System Design / Development	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Active	Active	Active	Active	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed
Testing & Evaluation	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Active	Active	Completed	Completed
Report Writing & Final Review	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	Active	Active	Active

08 & 09 | Expected Outcomes & References



EXPECTED OUTCOMES

What to include:

- What will be produced? (e.g., system, app, report)
- How will it solve the identified problem?
- Who will benefit from this project?
- Measurable results you expect to achieve
- Contribution to the field or industry



REFERENCES

Harvard Referencing Format:

Author Surname, Initial(s). (Year). Title of Book. Publisher.

Tips:

- Minimum 8–10 references
- Mix: books, journals, websites
- All in-text citations must appear in reference list
- Use Cite This For Me or Mendeley tool
- No Wikipedia as a main source

Tips for a Strong Proposal



Write clearly and simply

Avoid jargon. Your proposal should be readable by someone outside your field.



Be specific, not vague

Instead of 'improve the system', say 'reduce login errors by 30%'.



Follow the word count

proposals are typically 2,000–3,000 words. Check your course guidelines.



Keep sections connected

Your objectives should link to your methodology, Gantt chart and expected outcomes.



Proofread carefully

Grammar errors reduce credibility. Use Grammarly or ask a peer to review.



Be realistic with timelines

Don't plan 5 major tasks in one week — spread work realistically in your Gantt chart.

Remember: A well-structured proposal shows your supervisor that you are ready to execute your project!

Create Your Own Project Proposal



Task: Write a complete 3-Month Project Proposal on a topic of your choice from the list below

Suggested Topics:

- Online Student Attendance Management System
- AI Chatbot for Student Helpdesk
- E-Commerce Platform for Local Businesses
- Hospital Appointment Booking System
- Smart Library Management System
- Mobile App for Campus Navigation



Your Proposal Must Include:

- Title Page
- Introduction & Background
- Problem Statement
- Aim & 3–5 SMART Objectives
- Brief Literature Review (3 sources)
- Methodology
- Gantt Chart (12 weeks)
- Expected Outcomes
- References (Harvard style)



Deadline: 3 Weeks from Today | **Word Count:** 2,000–3,000 words | **Format:** MS Word / PDF